



DECISION TOOL · ONE PAGE

The AI Delegation *Decision Tree*

Before you decide a task needs an “agent,” find the lowest level that does the job. Start at the top, follow the answers, and check the result against the five tests below.

A task you are thinking of handing to AI

Will it act on its own, without a person triggering each run?

NO · A PERSON STAYS IN THE LOOP

YES · IT RUNS WITHOUT YOU

Do you reuse it for a recurring task?

Does it follow a fixed path you designed in advance?

NO

Answer

A one-off question, draft or summary. You decide what happens next.

YES

Assist

A reusable assistant with standing instructions. You still drive.

YES

Automate

A predefined workflow. Predictable inputs, route and outputs.

NO

Act

An agent that decides its own steps. The most powerful, the most to govern.

CHECK YOUR ANSWER AGAINST THE FIVE TESTS

	Answer	Assist	Automate	Act
Autonomy	None	Low	Medium	High
Access (what it can touch)	Read only	Read only	Read / write	Can act
Reversibility	Full	Full	Mostly	Often low
Risk of a confident error	Low	Low	Medium	High
Human approval	Inherent	Inherent	Design a checkpoint	Required by design

ALWAYS REQUIRE EXPLICIT HUMAN APPROVAL WHEN

the action is **hard to reverse**, the **consequence of an error is high**, or the decision has a **legal or similarly significant effect** on a person (a job offer, a loan, a contract). Under UK GDPR Article 22, that human involvement must be active, not a rubber stamp.

Book an AI Reality Check

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